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Northwind Labs Remote Work and Equipment Policy

Policy number HR-214 · Version 3.2 · Effective January 15, 2026 · Owner: People Operations

1. Purpose

Northwind Labs supports flexible work where the role allows it. This policy explains who can work remotely, how to request it, what the company provides for a home workspace, and the security rules that apply wherever you work. It replaces the 2023 Hybrid Work Guidelines.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Northwind Labs in the United States and Canada who have completed their 90-day introductory period. Interns, temporary staff and independent contractors are not covered; their remote arrangements are set in their individual agreements.

Employees in client-facing field roles, laboratory roles and facilities roles are generally not eligible for fully remote work, because their work requires regular on-site presence. They may still request occasional remote days under section 4.

3. Definitions

Remote-first: the employee works from home or another approved location and is not assigned a desk in a Northwind office.

Hybrid: the employee works in the office two set days a week and remotely on the other days.

Office-based: the employee works from a Northwind office every scheduled workday, with occasional remote days approved by their manager.

Home time zone: the time zone of the employee's team, as listed in Workday.

4. Eligibility and approval

Every role is assigned one of the three work arrangements in section 3 when it is created. To change your arrangement, submit form RW-1 (Remote Work Request) in Workday. The form asks for the arrangement you want, your proposed work location and how you will meet the availability rules in section 5.

Your manager reviews the request first and then sends it to People Operations. You will receive a decision within 10 business days of submitting the form. If the request is declined, the decision will include the reason and the earliest date you can apply again, which is never more than six months later.

Approved arrangements are reviewed once a year during the annual performance cycle. A manager may end a remote or hybrid arrangement with 30 days' written notice if the role's needs change or the availability rules are not being met.

4.1 Occasional remote days

Office-based employees may work remotely up to four days per calendar month with their manager's approval. Approval can be given in writing by email or chat; no form is needed for occasional days.

4.2 Moving to a new home address

If you plan to move, tell People Operations at least 30 days before the move. Some states and provinces have different payroll and tax rules, and a move outside the United States or Canada requires a new approval through form RW-1.

5. Working hours and availability

Northwind Labs has core hours of 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. in your team's home time zone, Monday through Friday. During core hours you are expected to be reachable on Slack and available for meetings. Outside core hours you may arrange your schedule with your manager, as long as you work your contracted hours.

Remote and hybrid employees whose location is in a different time zone must keep at least four hours of overlap with their home time zone each workday. During core hours, reply to direct messages within two hours. Mark yourself away in Slack and update your calendar when you are unavailable.

5.1 Working from another country

You may work temporarily from a country other than the one you are employed in for up to 30 days per calendar year. Request it through form RW-1 at least four weeks before you travel, so Legal can confirm that the stay does not create tax or immigration issues. Working from countries under U.S. or Canadian trade sanctions is never permitted.

5.2 Meetings

Teams with remote members should default to video meetings with cameras optional, share an agenda in advance, and post written notes afterward so that people in other time zones are not disadvantaged.

6. Equipment and expenses

The IT team provides every employee with a company laptop, a monitor, a keyboard and a headset. Company equipment remains Northwind property and must be returned within 14 days of your last day of employment, using the prepaid shipping kit IT will send you.

6.1 Home office stipend

Remote-first and hybrid employees receive a one-time home office stipend of $750 to buy a desk, chair, lighting or other workspace items. The stipend renews every three years. Unused amounts do not roll over.

6.2 Internet and coworking

Remote-first and hybrid employees are reimbursed up to $60 per month for home internet service. Remote-first employees who prefer a coworking space may instead claim up to $200 per month for a coworking membership; the two cannot be claimed in the same month.

6.3 Submitting expenses

Submit all expenses in Expensify within 30 days of the purchase, with an itemized receipt. Expenses submitted later than 90 days after the purchase will not be reimbursed. Reimbursements are paid with the next regular payroll after approval.

7. Security and data protection

The same security rules apply at home, in a coworking space and while traveling.

Use the company VPN whenever you connect from a network you do not control, such as public Wi-Fi in a café, hotel or airport. Multi-factor authentication must be turned on for every company account. Set your laptop to lock automatically after five minutes of inactivity, and lock it manually whenever you step away.

Customer data must never be stored on personal devices, including personal phones, tablets and USB drives. Do not print confidential documents at home. If you need a paper copy, print it in a Northwind office and dispose of it in a secure shredding bin.

7.1 Lost or stolen devices

If a company laptop or phone is lost or stolen, report it to the Security team at security@northwind.example within 24 hours, and file a police report if it was stolen. Security will lock and wipe the device remotely. You will not be charged for a lost device unless it was lost through repeated negligence.

8. Travel and in-person time

Hybrid employees work in the office on Tuesdays and Thursdays unless their team agrees on different days with People Operations.

Each team meets in person for a team summit once a quarter. Northwind pays for summit travel: economy airfare or train tickets booked at least 21 days ahead, and hotel rooms up to $220 per night. Meals during the summit are provided.

9. Questions and policy review

Send questions about this policy to People Operations at people-ops@northwind.example. People Operations reviews this policy every year and publishes changes at least 30 days before they take effect.

Revision history

Version	Date	Change
3.2	January 15, 2026	Raised the internet reimbursement from $50 to $60 per month.
3.1	June 1, 2025	Added rules for working from another country.
3.0	February 3, 2025	Replaced the 2023 Hybrid Work Guidelines.